

INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/BakerTillyUS/>

Interview thesis

The next phase is not more AI use cases. It is a repeatable conversion from AI capability into stronger consulting work, better economics, protected judgment, and justified scale.

What the role is really solving

Enterprise AI capacity and identified opportunities do not automatically produce changed consulting delivery. The missing system is business-owned portfolio activation: prioritization, practice redesign, technical translation, adoption, measurement, and scale decisions.

Why now

Baker Tilly is expanding, integrating, and publicly investing in governed AI systems around professional expertise. The strategic opportunity is to make that investment compound across Consulting without flattening practice-specific work or professional judgment.

Candidate thesis

AI becomes a consulting advantage only when the work, economics, judgment model, and adoption system change together.

Immediate contribution

Establish a transparent portfolio mechanism, sharpen business-to-technology requests, create measurable pilot-to-scale criteria, and mobilize practice ownership.

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Interview strategy

Lead with the rare integrated fit; handle the strongest objection through evidence and a practical working session, not defensive disclaimers.

Strongest plausible concern

Russell has not held a formal AI leadership role inside a national accounting partnership. The relevant question is whether his operating pattern transfers into a complex multi-practice professional-services environment.

Evidence-based response

- Direct AI-first operating transformation spanning technical and business systems.
- Applied AI portfolio frameworks, agentic workflow patterns, governance, evaluation, and human review.
- Scaled operating mechanisms at Amazon, evaluation, and human review.